

SC01 SUPPORT HANDWASHING | O (MAX: 1 PT)

Intent: Ensure support of hygienic hand washing practices for all individuals.

Summary: This feature requires projects to improve hygiene by offering hygienic soap containers and hand drying support.

Issue: All humans share the critical need to access to bathrooms and proper hand hygiene is key to reduce the incidence of gastrointestinal and respiratory diseases.⁵ Soap has been found to be more effective at removing germs than hand sanitizer in non-healthcare settings, as sanitizers' effect is impeded by dirty or greasy hands.¹⁰ Despite hand washing, hands can only become as clean as the surrounding environment. Sinks may harbor pathogenic bacteria that can migrate onto hands during washing.¹¹ Water splashing from the drain may spread bacteria to surrounding areas.^{12–15} Additionally, soap and the inside of liquid soap containers often remain contaminated after use; thus, best practice and research recommends that soap dispensers not be topped off.^{13,14} Lastly, once an individual's hands are cleaned, they can more easily become re-infected when wet compared to when dry.^{11,16}

Solutions: Bathrooms can be designed and furnished to ease hygiene. Visual cues that promote hand hygiene may improve compliance with established guidelines in certain segments of the population.^{17–19}

Part 1 Part 1 (Max: 1 Pt)

For All Spaces except Dwelling Units & Guest Rooms:

For all sinks where handwashing is expected (e.g., bathrooms, break rooms, food prep and wellness rooms), the following are present within the room:

- a. Fragrance-free liquid hand soap dispensed through one of the following:
 1. Sealed dispensers equipped with disposable soap cartridges.
 2. Dispensers with detachable and closed containers for soap refill. Soap containers must be washed and disinfected when emptied, before refilling.
- b. One of the following methods for hand drying:
 1. Fabric hand towel rolls with dispensers, with rolls replaced before reaching their end of service.
 2. Paper towels.
 3. Hand dryers equipped with a HEPA filter. Filter replacement and equipment maintenance are carried out per manufacturer's instructions. (NOTE: This method is not available for healthcare projects.)
 4. Washable fabric hand towels accompanied by a used towel container placed nearby. Towels are washed before reuse.
- c. Signage displaying steps for proper hand washing.

For Commercial Kitchen Spaces & Commercial Dining Spaces:

The following requirement is met:

- a. Clear signage directing toward the nearest handwashing location is present at the entrance to all areas intended for food preparation or consumption.

For messages.Guest Rooms:

The following are provided in each bathroom:

- a. Fragrance-free hand soap via one of the following:
 1. Individually wrapped bar soap, replaced during room turnover, and drainable soap bar racks.
 2. Sealed dispensers of liquid soap equipped with disposable soap cartridges.
 3. Liquid soap dispensers with detachable and closed containers for soap refill. Soap containers must be washed and disinfected when emptied, before refilling.
- b. One of the following methods for hand drying:

1. Reusable cloth towels, replaced and washed at least during room changeover.
2. Paper towels.
3. Hand dryers equipped with a HEPA filter. Filter replacement and equipment maintenance are carried out per manufacturer's instructions.
4. Fabric hand towel rolls with dispensers, with rolls replaced before reaching their end of service.